Inglés de B1 a C1

Niveles B1+ y B2

Teoría, práctica, ejercicios con el formato del Cambridge C1 Advanced y lecturas para estudiar en papel. Es el mismo contenido que la app, unidad por unidad. Las soluciones están al final: no las mires hasta terminar cada ejercicio.

Los textos y ejercicios son originales; solo imitan la estructura del examen.

Unidad 1 · El esqueleto de la frase (B1+)
Sujeto, verbo y complementos. Cómo leer frases largas.

Unidad 2 · Oraciones de relativo (B1+)
who, which, that, whose, where. Cuándo se omiten.

Unidad 3 · Present perfect o past simple (B1+)
Pasado terminado frente a pasado conectado con el presente.

Unidad 4 · La pasiva (B1+)
Quién recibe la acción. Todos los tiempos.

Unidad 5 · Conectores de contraste y causa (B1+)
although, however, despite, because of, so…

Unidad 6 · Narrar en pasado (B1+)
Past continuous, past perfect y used to.

Unidad 7 · Condicionales 0, 1 y 2 (B1+)
Situaciones reales e hipotéticas.

Unidad 8 · Verbo + -ing o + to (B1+)
enjoy doing, decide to do, stop/remember/try.

Unidad 9 · Tercer condicional y mixtos (B2)
Hablar de un pasado que no pasó.

Unidad 10 · Wish e if only (B2)
Deseos y arrepentimientos.

Soluciones

Anexo · Verbos irregulares

El esqueleto de la frase

Sujeto, verbo y complementos. Cómo leer frases largas.

Teoría

La idea clave

Toda frase en inglés, por larga que sea, tiene un **esqueleto**: **sujeto + verbo** (y casi siempre algo que completa al verbo). Todo lo demás son piezas que cuelgan de ese esqueleto.

Cuando una frase larga te lía, el problema casi nunca es que no conozcas las palabras: es que intentas entenderla **de izquierda a derecha, palabra por palabra**. En inglés funciona mejor **buscar primero el esqueleto** y después ir colgando el resto.

> The man is a doctor.
> The man who lives next door to my parents is a doctor.

Las dos frases dicen lo mismo en lo esencial: *el hombre es médico*. La segunda solo añade *qué hombre*.

El orden en inglés es casi fijo

En español podemos mover las piezas («Llegó ayer mi hermano», «Mi hermano llegó ayer»). En inglés el orden normal es siempre:

Sujeto → Verbo → Complemento → (lugar) → (tiempo)

> My brother arrived yesterday. ✓
> ~~Arrived yesterday my brother.~~ ✗

Y el sujeto **siempre aparece**, aunque en español lo quitemos:

> ~~Is raining.~~ ✗ → It is raining. ✓
> ~~Is important to rest.~~ ✗ → It is important to rest. ✓

Esto es una ventaja al leer: **lo que va justo delante del verbo principal es (casi siempre) el sujeto**.

Cómo reconocer el verbo principal

El verbo principal es el que está **conjugado** (lleva tiempo: presente, pasado, futuro…). Los auxiliares van con él y forman un solo bloque:

> works · has been working · will work · can work · was built · didn't know

No son el verbo principal:

- Los **infinitivos** con *to*: *She decided to leave* → el principal es *decided*.

- Las formas en **-ing** o **-ed** sin auxiliar delante: *The woman sitting there **is** my aunt* → el principal es *is*.
- Los verbos que van **después de who, which, that, because, when, if, although…**: pertenecen a una oración secundaria.

Las piezas que cuelgan del esqueleto

Casi todo lo que hace larga una frase es una de estas cinco piezas. Aprende a reconocerlas por la palabra con la que empiezan:

Pieza	Empieza por…	Ejemplo
Relativa	who, which, that, whose, where	the book that I bought
Subordinada	because, when, if, although, while, since, after	Although it was late, we went out.
Preposición + nombre	in, on, at, with, for, of, during…	During the summer, prices rise.
Participio	-ing, -ed (sin auxiliar)	the money spent on education
Conector	however, therefore, moreover, and, but	However, nobody noticed.

Truco: **tapa mentalmente esas piezas** y lo que queda es el esqueleto.

El método de los 4 pasos

1. **Busca los verbos conjugados** de la frase.
2. **Descarta** los que van detrás de who/which/that/because/when/if/although…
3. El que queda es el **verbo principal**. Lo que va delante es el **sujeto** (quita las piezas que cuelgan de él).
4. Lee el esqueleto en voz alta y **después** añade las piezas una a una.

> Last year, the company that my sister works for opened three new offices in Asia.

Verbos conjugados: *works* y *opened*. *Works* va detrás de *that* → secundaria. Esqueleto: **the company opened three new offices**. Luego: ¿qué compañía? la de mi hermana. ¿Cuándo? el año pasado. ¿Dónde? en Asia.

Errores típicos de hispanohablantes

- ~~Is very interesting this book.~~ → **This book is very interesting.** El sujeto va delante.
- ~~Yesterday went I to the cinema.~~ → **Yesterday I went to the cinema.** Aunque empieces por el tiempo, después va sujeto + verbo.
- ~~Exist many problems.~~ → **There are many problems.** Para «hay/existen» se usa *there is / there are*.
- Al leer: tomar el primer verbo que ves como principal. En *People who exercise regularly **sleep** better*, el principal es **sleep**.

Práctica

1. Toca el verbo principal (todas sus palabras).
   My neighbour has lived in this building for twenty years.

2. Toca el verbo principal.
   The students who passed the exam received a certificate.

3. Toca el sujeto del verbo principal (solo el núcleo, sin la relativa).
   The film that we saw last night was really boring.

4. Toca el verbo principal.
   Although she was tired, Laura finished the report before midnight.

5. Toca el sujeto.
   In most European countries, children start school at the age of six.

6. Toca el verbo principal.
   People who exercise regularly tend to sleep better.

7. ¿Cuál es el esqueleto de esta frase?
   The decision to close the old factory, which had employed hundreds of local people, was announced on Monday.

   A The factory was announced on Monday **B** The decision was announced

   C Hundreds of people was announced **D** The old factory had employed people

8. ¿Cuál es el verbo principal?
   Anyone wishing to apply for the course should send an email before Friday.

   A wishing **B** should send **C** to apply **D** apply

9. Elige la frase correcta.

   A It is important to drink water. **B** Important is to drink water. **C** Is important drink water.

   D Is important to drink water.

10. Elige la frase correcta.

    A Exist many problems in this city. **B** There are many problems in this city.

    C Many problems exist in this city they. **D** Has many problems this city.

11. Ordena la frase.
    Yesterday / a / bought / car / my / new / parents

    _____

12. Ordena la frase.
    The / boss / called / is / my / who / woman / you

    _____

13. _____ is raining again, so take an umbrella.

14. _____ are three restaurants near my house.

Cambridge C1 · Reading and Use of English

Part 1 · Multiple-choice cloze (1–8)

Read the text and choose the answer (A, B, C or D) that fits each gap best.

Never too late to learn

When Marta turned forty, she **(1)** a decision that surprised everyone: she would finally learn English properly. She had studied it at school, but she could only **(2)** the time and order a coffee. At first she found it hard to **(3)** time for classes, because she worked long hours. So she **(4)** her alarm half an hour earlier and studied before breakfast. After a few months, she was able to **(5)** part in short conversations with tourists in her shop. Her biggest **(6)** was understanding native speakers, who seemed to speak incredibly fast. Her teacher gave her a useful piece of **(7)**: listen for the verb first, and the rest of the sentence will **(8)** sense.

1	**A** made	**B** took	**C** did	**D** got
2	**A** talk	**B** say	**C** speak	**D** tell
3	**A** give	**B** put	**C** make	**D** do
4	**A** fixed	**B** put	**C** placed	**D** set
5	**A** join	**B** make	**C** have	**D** take
6	**A** challenge	**B** effort	**C** trial	**D** attempt
7	**A** advice	**B** suggestion	**C** tip	**D** idea
8	**A** give	**B** make	**C** have	**D** do

Part 2 · Open cloze (9–16)

Read the text and write one word in each gap.

Why word order matters

In Spanish, you can often leave out the subject, but in English **(9)** is almost always necessary. You cannot simply say "is raining"; you have to say "**(10)** is raining". In the same way, to say that something exists, English uses "there": "**(11)** are three reasons for this." The basic order is subject, verb and object, and it rarely changes. "The dog bit the man" means something very different **(12)** "The man bit the dog". Adverbs like "often" usually go before the main verb, but after the verb "to **(13)**": "She is often late." Questions need an auxiliary verb: "Where **(14)** you live?" Learners who understand this pattern find long sentences much easier, **(15)** they know where to look for the verb. Once you can find the skeleton of a sentence, everything else is just extra information **(16)** has been added around it.

Part 3 · Word formation (17–24)

Use the word in capitals to form a word that fits each gap.

> **A good language teacher**
>
> The most **(17)** SUCCESS learners are not always the most intelligent ones. Research shows that **(18)** MOTIVATE matters far more than talent. A good teacher gives clear **(19)** EXPLAIN and never makes students feel **(20)** COMFORT when they make mistakes. In fact, mistakes are a natural part of **(21)** LEARN. Students also need regular **(22)** ENCOURAGE from their teachers. It is also **(23)** USE to read every day, even **(24)** SIMPLE texts written for learners.

Part 4 · Key word transformation (25–30)

Complete the second sentence so that it means the same as the first. Use the word given without changing it, and write between three and six words.

25. It's not necessary for you to bring anything.

    HAVE

    You _____ anything.

26. There were a lot of people at the concert.

    CROWDED

    The concert _____ people.

27. My brother is taller than me.

    AS

    I'm _____ my brother.

28. What time does the film start?

    KNOW

    Do you _____ starts?

29. I find grammar really interesting.

    INTERESTED

    I _____ grammar.

30. Where is the station? Can you tell me?

    WHERE

    Can you tell me _____ ?

Lectura · Why we forget what we read

Most of us have had the same experience: we finish a book, and a few weeks later we can remember almost nothing about it. This is not a sign that our memory is getting worse. In fact, researchers who

study memory say that forgetting is completely normal. The brain keeps information that it uses often and throws away the rest. When we read a novel in one weekend, we give the brain very few chances to return to the story. People who read a chapter a day and think about it before the next one remember much more. Writing a short summary or explaining the plot to a friend is even more effective. So if you want to remember a book, the answer is simple: read it more slowly and talk about it.

Vocabulario

experience experiencia · **almost nothing** casi nada · **a few weeks later** unas semanas después · **most of us** la mayoría de nosotros · **remember** recordar · **a sign** una señal · **get worse** empeorar · **memory** memoria; recuerdo · **in fact** de hecho · **researcher** investigador/a · **forgetting** olvidar (el hecho de olvidar) · **study** estudiar, investigar · **completely** completamente · **keep** guardar, conservar · **throw away** tirar, desechar · **the rest** el resto · **brain** cerebro · **often** a menudo · **novel** novela · **chance** oportunidad, ocasión · **return to** volver a · **very few** muy pocos · **in one weekend** en un solo fin de semana · **chapter** capítulo · **the next one** el siguiente · **a day** al día · **think about** pensar en · **much more** mucho más · **summary** resumen · **plot** trama, argumento · **effective** eficaz · **explain** explicar · **even more** aún más · **slowly** despacio · **talk about** hablar de · **answer** respuesta · **simple** sencillo

Preguntas

1. According to the text, forgetting what we read…

   A only happens with long books. **B** is a sign of a bad memory. **C** is completely normal.

   D happens more to older people.

2. Why do we forget a novel we read in one weekend?

   A Because we read too fast to understand. **B** Because we are tired at weekends.

   C Because the brain has few chances to return to the story. **D** Because novels are too long.

3. What does the writer suggest?

   A Reading more books. **B** Reading the same book twice. **C** Reading shorter books.

   D Reading slowly and talking about the book.

Oraciones de relativo

who, which, that, whose, where. Cuándo se omiten.

Teoría

Para qué sirven

Una oración de relativo es una pieza que **dice algo más de un nombre**: qué persona, qué cosa, qué lugar. Es la pieza que más alarga las frases de los textos, así que reconocerla es la mitad del trabajo al leer.

I met a woman. *She* speaks six languages.
→ I met a woman who speaks six languages.

Qué pronombre usar

Pronombre	Para	Ejemplo
who	personas	the teacher who helped me
which	cosas y animales	the phone which I bought
that	personas o cosas (más informal)	the film that won the prize
whose	posesión («cuyo»)	the man whose car was stolen
where	lugares	the town where I grew up
when	momentos	the day when we met

En español casi siempre decimos «que». En inglés hay que elegir: **personas** → **who**, **cosas** → **which**, y **that** vale para las dos.

Con comas o sin comas

Hay dos tipos y cambian el significado:

Sin comas (especificativa): My brother who lives in London is a nurse.
→ Tengo varios hermanos; hablo del que vive en Londres.

Con comas (explicativa): My brother, who lives in London, is a nurse.
→ Solo tengo un hermano; de paso digo que vive en Londres.

Reglas de las de **comas**: no se puede usar **that** y el pronombre **nunca** se omite.

My car, ~~that~~ **which** is ten years old, still works perfectly.

Cuándo desaparece el pronombre

Esto es lo que más confunde al leer. Si el pronombre es el **objeto** (detrás viene otro sujeto), en las relativas sin comas se puede **quitar**, y los nativos lo quitan casi siempre:

> The book (that) I read last summer was amazing.
> The people (who) we met in Rome were very friendly.

Pista para leer: si ves **nombre + sujeto + verbo** seguidos (*the book I read*, *the man she married*), ahí hay una relativa escondida. Mentalmente, añade «que».

> The house they bought needs a lot of work. → La casa *que* compraron necesita mucho trabajo.

Si el pronombre es el **sujeto** de la relativa (detrás viene directamente el verbo), **no** se puede quitar: *the man who lives here*.

Relativas reducidas (-ing / -ed)

En los textos verás a menudo relativas «comprimidas» sin pronombre ni verbo conjugado:

> the woman sitting by the window = the woman who is sitting by the window
> a novel written in 1850 = a novel which was written in 1850
> products made in China = products which are made in China

-ing = sentido activo (la persona hace algo). **-ed / participio** = sentido pasivo (a la cosa le hacen algo). Recuerda de la unidad 1: estas formas **no** son el verbo principal.

Preposición al final

En inglés normal la preposición se queda al final de la relativa. Es muy frecuente y al principio despista:

> the company my sister works for → la empresa *para la que* trabaja mi hermana
> the person I was talking to → la persona *con la que* hablaba

La versión formal pone la preposición delante y obliga a usar **whom** o **which**: *the person to whom I was talking*.

Errores típicos de hispanohablantes

- ~~The book that I read it was great.~~ → **The book that I read was great.** No se repite el objeto («que lo leí»).
- ~~The man which lives here…~~ → **The man who lives here…** Personas con *who*.
- ~~My mother, that is a teacher, …~~ → **My mother, who is a teacher, …** Con comas no hay *that*.
- ~~The city where I live in…~~ → **The city where I live** o **the city I live in**. No las dos cosas.
- ~~A friend who his father is a pilot~~ → **A friend whose father is a pilot**.

Práctica

1. The woman ___ lives upstairs is a musician.
   A who **B** whose **C** where **D** which
2. This is the café ___ we first met.
   A who **B** whose **C** where **D** which
3. I have a friend ___ brother plays for Barcelona.
   A who's **B** who **C** whose **D** which
4. My grandmother, ___ is 90, still drives.
   A who **B** which **C** that **D** — (nada)
5. ¿En qué frase se puede quitar el pronombre?
   A My car, which is red, is outside. **B** The film that we watched was boring.
   C The film that won the prize was boring. **D** The man who called you is here.
6. ¿Qué significa?
   The flat they rented was tiny.
   A El piso que alquilaron era diminuto. **B** Ellos alquilaron un piso diminuto.
   C El piso alquiló a ellos. **D** Alquilaron el piso y era diminuto.
7. ¿Cuál es el verbo principal?
   The students taking the exam tomorrow must bring their ID.
   A taking **B** take **C** must bring **D** bring
8. Elige la frase correcta.
   A The book who I lent you was mine. **B** The book that I lent you it was mine.
   C The book what I lent you was mine. **D** The book that I lent you was mine.
9. That's the girl _____ dog bit me.
10. The bus _____ goes to the airport leaves every hour.
11. I'll never forget the day _____ I passed my driving test.
12. Is this the person you were talking _____?
13. Toca el verbo principal.
    The houses built after the war were quite small.
14. Toca el verbo principal.
    The restaurant my parents recommended has closed down.
15. Ordena la frase.
    I / The / a / found / gave / man / me / reward / wallet / whose
    _____

Cambridge C1 · Reading and Use of English

Part 1 · Multiple-choice cloze (1–8)

Read the text and choose the answer (A, B, C or D) that fits each gap best.

The town that saved its cinema

Ten years ago, the small cinema in Bridgeford was about to **(1)** down. It was an old building **(2)** needed expensive repairs, and fewer and fewer people were going. Then a group of neighbours decided to **(3)** action. They **(4)** money by organising concerts and markets, and within a year they had enough to repair the roof. Today the cinema is run by volunteers, most of whom had no previous **(5)** of running a business. It shows a **(6)** range of films, from new releases to old classics. Tickets are cheap, and the cinema has become a **(7)** place for families. "It's more than a cinema," says one volunteer. "It's **(8)** the whole town meets."

1	**A** finish	**B** close	**C** stop	**D** end
2	**A** who	**B** whose	**C** what	**D** which
3	**A** give	**B** make	**C** take	**D** do
4	**A** raised	**B** rose	**C** grew	**D** lifted
5	**A** practice	**B** habit	**C** experience	**D** skill
6	**A** tall	**B** long	**C** big	**D** wide
7	**A** liked	**B** favourite	**C** chosen	**D** preferred
8	**A** where	**B** what	**C** which	**D** that

Part 2 · Open cloze (9–16)

Read the text and write one word in each gap.

A letter from my grandmother

Last week I found a letter **(9)** my grandmother wrote in 1965. The woman to **(10)** it was addressed was her best friend, Elena, **(11)** had moved to Argentina. In the letter, my grandmother describes the village **(12)** she grew up and the house **(13)** roof was always leaking. She also mentions the day **(14)** she met my grandfather, at a dance in the main square. Elena, **(15)** letters are also in a box in our attic, wrote back every month for forty years. Reading them, I realised how little I knew about the people **(16)** I thought I knew best.

Part 3 · Word formation (17–24)

Use the word in capitals to form a word that fits each gap.

> **The volunteers behind the festival**
>
> Every summer, our town organises a music festival which is completely **(17)** DEPEND on volunteers. People **(18)** WILL give up their weekends to help, and the **(19)** ORGANISE work all year to find the right bands. The festival has grown **(20)** CONSIDER since it started. Many of the **(21)** PERFORM are local, and the event attracts thousands of **(22)** VISIT from all over the country. It has a huge **(23)** ECONOMY impact on the area, and the atmosphere is always **(24)** FRIEND.

Part 4 · Key word transformation (25–30)

Complete the second sentence so that it means the same as the first. Use the word given without changing it, and write between three and six words.

25. I met a man. His dog had won a prize.

    WHOSE

    I met a man _____ won a prize.

26. That's the hotel. We stayed there last summer.

    WHERE

    That's the hotel _____ last summer.

27. The woman is my aunt. She is talking to Tom.

    WHO

    The woman _____ Tom is my aunt.

28. I don't remember the year. We moved to Madrid then.

    WHEN

    I don't remember the year _____ to Madrid.

29. Paris is the city. I'd most like to visit it.

    WHICH

    Paris is the city _____ most like to visit.

30. The film was boring. We saw it last night.

    THAT

    The film _____ last night was boring.

Lectura · The library that never closes

In a small village in Wales there is a red telephone box that no longer has a telephone. Instead, the shelves people have built inside it are full of books which anyone can borrow for free. The idea came

from a retired teacher whose house is next to the box. She wanted to create a place where neighbours could share the books they had already read. Today the box, which is open day and night, contains more than three hundred books. Visitors passing through the village often stop to take a photo or leave a book of their own. The teacher says that the books people choose to leave tell you a lot about the village.

Vocabulario

telephone box cabina de teléfono · **no longer** ya no · **instead** en su lugar · **shelf / shelves** estante(s) · **borrow** tomar prestado · **for free** gratis · **retired** jubilado/a · **next to** al lado de · **create** crear · **neighbour** vecino/a · **share** compartir · **day and night** día y noche · **contain** contener · **pass through** pasar por · **leave** dejar · **of their own** suyo propio · **choose** elegir, decidir · **a lot about** mucho sobre

Preguntas

1. What is special about the telephone box?

   A It is only open during the day. **B** It still has a working telephone. **C** It is used as a small library. **D** It is the oldest in Wales.

2. Who had the idea?

   A A telephone company. **B** The local council. **C** A group of visitors. **D** A retired teacher who lives next to it.

3. According to the teacher, the books people leave…

   A are sold to visitors. **B** are mostly for children. **C** say a lot about the village. **D** are usually very old.

Present perfect o past simple

Pasado terminado frente a pasado conectado con el presente.

Teoría

La pregunta clave: ¿el momento está terminado?

Los dos tiempos hablan de cosas que pasaron, pero miran el pasado de forma distinta:

Past simple = pasado cerrado · Present perfect = pasado conectado con ahora

> I lost my keys yesterday. → Pasó ayer. Fin de la historia.
> I have lost my keys. → Las he perdido y **ahora** no las tengo.

Si dices **cuándo** pasó (yesterday, in 2019, last week, two days ago, when I was a child), el momento está cerrado: **past simple**.

Cómo se forman

	Past simple	Present perfect
+	She **worked** / **went**	She **has worked** / **has gone**
–	She **didn't work**	She **hasn't worked**
?	**Did** she **work**?	**Has** she **worked**?

El present perfect es **have/has + participio**. Los verbos irregulares tienen participio propio: *go* → *went* → ***gone***, *see* → *saw* → ***seen***, *write* → *wrote* → ***written***.

Cuándo se usa el present perfect

- **Experiencias** a lo largo de tu vida, sin decir cuándo: *I'**ve been** to Japan twice.* · *Have you ever **tried** sushi?*
- **Algo que empezó en el pasado y sigue**, con *for* y *since*: *We'**ve lived** here for ten years.* (y seguimos aquí)
- **Un resultado que importa ahora**: *Someone **has broken** the window.* (está rota)
- **Un periodo que aún no ha terminado**: *today, this week, this year*: *I'**ve drunk** three coffees today.*
- Con **just, already, yet**: *She'**s just left**.* · *Have you finished **yet**?* · *I'**ve already** paid.*

Palabras que te dan la pista

Past simple	Present perfect
yesterday · last night/week/year · in 2019 · ago · when…? · then	ever · never · just · already · yet · so far · since · for (hasta ahora) · recently

Ojo con «ago»: siempre va con past simple. *I met her two years ago* ✓ · ~~*I have met her two years ago*~~ ✗

Ojo con «for»: depende de si la situación sigue. *I **lived** in Paris for two years* (ya no vivo allí) · *I'**ve lived** in Paris for two years* (sigo viviendo allí).

En los textos: noticias e historias

Las noticias suelen empezar en present perfect (lo nuevo, lo que importa ahora) y luego cuentan los detalles en past simple:

> A local student has won a national science prize. She designed a cheap water filter and presented it in Madrid last month.

Cuando leas, fíjate en este cambio: el present perfect anuncia, el past simple narra.

Errores típicos de hispanohablantes

- ~~I have seen him yesterday.~~ → **I saw him yesterday.** En español decimos «lo he visto hoy/ayer» con más libertad; en inglés, si hay un momento terminado, past simple.
- ~~I live here since 2015.~~ → **I've lived here since 2015.** «Vivo aquí desde…» se dice con present perfect.
- ~~How long are you here?~~ → **How long have you been here?**
- ~~Did you ever go to London?~~ → **Have you ever been to London?** Experiencia en tu vida → present perfect, y con *been to*.

Práctica

1. I ___ my phone. I can't find it anywhere.
   A was losing **B** have lost **C** lose **D** lost
2. We ___ to Italy last summer.
   A go **B** have gone **C** have been **D** went
3. She ___ in this company since 2020.
   A is working **B** has worked **C** worked **D** works
4. ___ you ever ___ a horse?
   A Have / rode **B** Have / ridden **C** Did / ride **D** Did / ridden
5. They got married three years ___.
   A before **B** ago **C** since **D** for
6. I ___ three coffees today, so no more for me!
   A 've had **B** had **C** have **D** was having
7. Have you finished your homework _____?
8. I've known Marta _____ we were at school together.
9. He has lived in Berlin _____ six years.
10. When _____ you start learning English?

11. Toca el verbo principal.
    The number of people who work from home has doubled since 2019.

12. Ordena la frase.
    I / Ireland / been / have / never / to
    _____

Cambridge C1 · Reading and Use of English

Part 1 · Multiple-choice cloze (1–8)

Read the text and choose the answer (A, B, C or D) that fits each gap best.

> **My first year abroad**
>
> It's been a year since I moved to Dublin, and I've already **(1)** a lot of new friends. At first it was difficult to **(2)** used to the weather, but now I hardly notice the rain. I've **(3)** jobs twice, and the one I have now **(4)** quite well. I've also **(5)** up running, and last month I **(6)** part in my first half marathon. My family is far away, but we have never **(7)** touch: we talk every Sunday. Moving here is probably the best thing I've ever **(8)**.

1	**A** made	**B** done	**C** had	**D** got
2	**A** be	**B** make	**C** have	**D** get
3	**A** exchanged	**B** turned	**C** moved	**D** changed
4	**A** gains	**B** earns	**C** pays	**D** wins
5	**A** made	**B** put	**C** taken	**D** got
6	**A** made	**B** took	**C** did	**D** had
7	**A** missed	**B** dropped	**C** failed	**D** lost
8	**A** made	**B** done	**C** had	**D** got

Part 2 · Open cloze (9–16)

Read the text and write one word in each gap.

> **Have you ever wondered…?**
>
> **(9)** you ever wondered why English has two past tenses? The present perfect connects the past with the present. We use it for experiences: "I have **(10)** been to Japan" means that at no time in my life have I gone there. We also use it for situations that started in the past and continue now: "I've lived here **(11)** three years" or "I've lived here **(12)** 2019". But if we say exactly when something happened, we need the past simple: "I visited Japan two years **(13)**." A common mistake among Spanish speakers is to say "I have seen him yesterday". This is wrong **(14)** yesterday is a finished time. Words like already and just are also typical: "I've **(15)** finished, a moment ago." And to ask about duration, we say: "**(16)** long have you known her?"

Part 3 · Word formation (17–24)

Use the word in capitals to form a word that fits each gap.

> **A life in pictures**
>
> The photographer Ana Ruiz has had a long and **(17)** REMARK career. Her **(18)** EXCITE about travel began when she was a child, and since then she has visited more than sixty countries. Her images have appeared in **(19)** NUMBER magazines. Her most famous **(20)** EXHIBIT opened in 2015 and received **(21)** ENTHUSIASM reviews. Critics have praised the **(22)** HONEST of her work. Recently she has become **(23)** INCREASE interested in climate change, and she has never been afraid of showing the **(24)** POOR she has seen.

Part 4 · Key word transformation (25–30)

Complete the second sentence so that it means the same as the first. Use the word given without changing it, and write between three and six words.

25. I started working here three years ago.

    FOR

    I _____ three years.

26. This is my first time in London.

    BEEN

    I _____ London before.

27. When did you buy your car?

    HAD

    How long _____ your car?

28. I last saw Peter in May.

    SEEN

    I _____ May.

29. She went to Rome and she's still there.

    GONE

    She _____ Rome.

30. It's two years since we last met.

    MET

    We _____ two years.

Lectura · The village that went offline

A small village in the north of Scotland has decided to switch off its public Wi-Fi every Sunday. The idea came from a group of parents who were worried about their children's screen time. Last spring they organised a meeting and most of the village voted in favour. Since then, the local café has started a board games afternoon and the library has seen more visitors than ever. Not everyone has been happy, however. Some teenagers complained that they had nothing to do, and two of them walked five kilometres to the next town to find a signal. But so far the experiment has worked and other villages have asked how they can do the same.

Vocabulario

switch off apagar · **public** público · **be worried about** estar preocupado por · **screen time** tiempo de pantalla · **vote in favour** votar a favor · **meeting** reunión · **since then** desde entonces · **board game** juego de mesa · **than ever** que nunca · **however** sin embargo · **not everyone** no todo el mundo · **complain** quejarse · **signal** señal, cobertura · **the next town** el pueblo de al lado · **so far** hasta ahora · **the same** lo mismo

Preguntas

1. What has the village decided to do?

   A Ban mobile phones. **B** Turn off public Wi-Fi on Sundays. **C** Build a new café.

   D Close the library on Sundays.

2. Who suggested the idea?

   A The teenagers. **B** Some worried parents. **C** The owner of the café. **D** The library staff.

3. How have other villages reacted?

   A They have ignored it. **B** They have copied it already. **C** They have asked for information.

   D They have criticised it.

La pasiva

Quién recibe la acción. Todos los tiempos.

Teoría

Para qué sirve

En la voz pasiva, el protagonista de la frase es **quien recibe la acción**, no quien la hace. Se usa cuando quién lo hace no importa, no se sabe o es obvio.

> Activa: Someone stole my bike.
> Pasiva: My bike was stolen. → Lo importante es la bici; el ladrón no se sabe.

En los textos (noticias, ciencia, informes) la pasiva aparece muchísimo. Si no la reconoces, entenderás al revés quién hace qué.

Cómo se forma

be (en el tiempo que toque) + participio

Tiempo	Pasiva
Presente	English **is spoken** here.
Pasado	The bridge **was built** in 1890.
Present perfect	The meeting **has been cancelled**.
Futuro	The results **will be published** on Monday.
Continuo	The road **is being repaired**.
Con modal	Phones **must be switched off**.

Truco: el verbo que cambia de tiempo es **be**. El participio siempre se queda igual.

Quién lo hace: by

Si quieres decir quién hizo la acción, usa **by**. Solo se añade cuando aporta información:

> Guernica was painted by Picasso. ✓ (dato importante)
> My bike was stolen ~~by someone~~. ✗ (no aporta nada)

Cómo reconocerla al leer

Busca **be + participio**. Cuidado, porque el participio puede parecer un pasado normal:

> The thief arrested the man. → el ladrón arrestó (activa, raro)
> The thief was arrested. → al ladrón lo arrestaron (pasiva)

Y recuerda la unidad 2: muchas veces la pasiva aparece «comprimida» como relativa reducida, sin *be*:

> The houses built after the war are small. = which were built

La pasiva y el «se» español

Muchas frases con «se» en español se dicen en inglés con pasiva:

> Se habla inglés. → English **is spoken**.
> Se construyó en 1890. → It **was built** in 1890.
> Se cancelaron los vuelos. → The flights **were cancelled**.

Errores típicos de hispanohablantes

- ~~The house was build in 1900.~~ → **was built**. Siempre participio, no infinitivo.
- ~~It is speaking English here.~~ → **English is spoken here.**
- ~~The letter was sended.~~ → **was sent**. Ojo con los irregulares.
- ~~I was born on 1998.~~ → **I was born in 1998.** «Nacer» en inglés es pasiva: *be born*.

Práctica

1. This castle ___ in the 12th century.
   A was built **B** built **C** has built **D** is building
2. Spanish ___ in more than 20 countries.
   A speaks **B** is spoken **C** is speaking **D** spoke
3. The match ___ because of the rain.
   A is cancelling **B** has been cancelled **C** cancelled **D** has cancelled
4. Your order ___ tomorrow morning.
   A is delivering **B** will deliver **C** delivers **D** will be delivered
5. The road ___ at the moment, so we have to go another way.
   A repairs **B** is repairing **C** is being repaired **D** has repaired
6. ¿Cuál es correcta?
   A I was born in 1998. **B** I was borned in 1998. **C** I born in 1998. **D** I am born in 1998.
7. The Mona Lisa was painted _____ Leonardo da Vinci.
8. Mobile phones must _____ switched off during the exam.
9. The winners will be _____ next week. (announce)
10. Toca el verbo principal (con su auxiliar).
    More than a million trees have been planted in the region since 2010.
11. Toca el sujeto.
    The new hospital, which was designed by a local architect, will be opened next year.

12. Ordena la frase.

The / arrested / by / police / the / thief / was

_____

Cambridge C1 · Reading and Use of English

Part 1 · Multiple-choice cloze (1–8)

Read the text and choose the answer (A, B, C or D) that fits each gap best.

> **How chocolate is made**
>
> Chocolate is made from the **(1)** of the cacao tree, which is **(2)** in hot countries near the equator. After the beans are picked, they are left in the sun to **(3)**. Then they are **(4)** to factories all over the world. In the factory, the beans are roasted and then **(5)** into a thick paste. Sugar and milk are **(6)** to this paste, and the mixture is **(7)** for hours until it becomes smooth. Finally, it is poured into moulds and left to **(8)** down.

1	**A** stones	**B** beans	**C** grains	**D** nuts
2	**A** grown	**B** raised	**C** bred	**D** built
3	**A** dry	**B** warm	**C** burn	**D** heat
4	**A** driven	**B** ridden	**C** travelled	**D** shipped
5	**A** torn	**B** cut	**C** ground	**D** broken
6	**A** added	**B** joined	**C** put	**D** mixed
7	**A** waved	**B** beaten	**C** stirred	**D** shaken
8	**A** chill	**B** cold	**C** freeze	**D** cool

Part 2 · Open cloze (9–16)

Read the text and write one word in each gap.

> **A famous theft**
>
> In 1911, the Mona Lisa **(9)** stolen from the Louvre in Paris. At first nobody noticed it was missing, and the theft was only discovered **(10)** following day. The painting had been taken **(11)** a man called Vincenzo Peruggia, who had worked in the museum. For two years, it was **(12)** seen. Peruggia was finally caught when he tried to sell it to a gallery in Florence. Today, the painting **(13)** visited by millions of people every year, and it is kept behind bulletproof glass **(14)** that nobody can damage it. Some historians believe the theft is the reason **(15)** the painting became so famous. Before 1911, it **(16)** hardly known outside the art world.

Part 3 · Word formation (17–24)

Use the word in capitals to form a word that fits each gap.

> **A new hospital**
>
> The new hospital, which was **(17)** OFFICIAL opened last week, was designed by a team of local **(18)** ARCHITECTURE. It is **(19)** EQUIP with the latest technology. The project was paid for by the regional **(20)** GOVERN, and its **(21)** CONSTRUCT took four years. Patients will no longer have to make long **(22)** JOURNEY to the city for **(23)** TREAT. The hospital is also expected to create about 500 jobs, which is great news for the area's **(24)** EMPLOY young people.

Part 4 · Key word transformation (25–30)

Complete the second sentence so that it means the same as the first. Use the word given without changing it, and write between three and six words.

25. They built this bridge in 1890.

    WAS

    This bridge _____ 1890.

26. Someone is repairing my car at the moment.

    BEING

    My car _____ at the moment.

27. People say that he is very rich.

    SAID

    He _____ very rich.

28. They will announce the results tomorrow.

    BE

    The results _____ tomorrow.

29. A mechanic checked my brakes last week.

    HAD

    I _____ last week.

30. Nobody has told me about the meeting.

    BEEN

    I _____ about the meeting.

Lectura · How a pencil is made

Billions of pencils are produced every year, but few people know how they are made. First, the wood is cut into thin blocks which are called slats. Then small grooves are made in each slat, and the "lead" is

placed inside them. Surprisingly, this "lead" is not made of lead at all: it is a mixture of graphite and clay. A second slat is glued on top, and the "sandwich" is cut into individual pencils. Finally, they are painted, sharpened and packed into boxes. The yellow colour that is used on most American pencils was chosen in the 1890s because the best graphite came from China, where yellow was linked to royalty.

Vocabulario

billion mil millones · **produce** producir, fabricar · **wood** madera · **thin** fino, delgado · **be called** llamarse · **groove** ranura · **place** colocar · **inside** dentro · **lead** plomo (y la mina del lápiz) · **not… at all** en absoluto · **mixture** mezcla · **clay** arcilla · **glue** pegar (con pegamento) · **on top** encima · **sharpen** sacar punta, afilar · **pack** empaquetar · **choose (chose, chosen)** elegir · **be linked to** estar asociado a · **royalty** la realeza

Preguntas

1. What is the "lead" in a pencil made of?

   A Wood and glue. **B** Paint. **C** Lead. **D** Graphite and clay.

2. What happens after the second slat is glued on top?

   A The "sandwich" is cut into pencils. **B** Grooves are made. **C** The lead is placed inside.

   D The pencils are painted.

3. Why are many American pencils yellow?

   A Yellow is easy to see. **B** The first pencil was yellow. **C** Yellow is the cheapest paint.

   D It was linked to Chinese royalty.

Conectores de contraste y causa

although, however, despite, because of, so…

Teoría

Por qué importan tanto

Los conectores son las **señales de tráfico** de un texto: te dicen si lo que viene a continuación va en la misma dirección, en contra o es una consecuencia. Si los reconoces, entiendes la lógica del texto aunque no sepas todas las palabras.

The hotel was expensive. However, … → viene algo bueno (contraste)
The hotel was expensive. As a result, … → viene una consecuencia

Lo que hay que saber de cada uno: qué va detrás

El gran problema no es el significado, sino la **gramática**: unos van con una frase completa y otros con un sustantivo.

Va con…	Contraste	Causa	Consecuencia
Frase (sujeto + verbo)	although, even though, while, whereas	because, as, since	so
Sustantivo o -ing	despite, in spite of	because of, due to	—
Frase nueva (tras punto o punto y coma)	however, nevertheless, on the other hand	—	therefore, as a result, consequently

Contraste: although, despite, however

Although it was raining, we went out. (frase completa)
Despite the rain, we went out. (sustantivo)
Despite feeling tired, she kept working. (-ing)
It was raining. However, we went out. (frase nueva, con coma detrás)

Even though es un *although* más fuerte. **Whereas / while** comparan dos cosas opuestas: *My sister loves cities, whereas I prefer the countryside.*

On the other hand presenta el otro lado de un argumento. **On the contrary** significa «al contrario, es justo lo opuesto», no es lo mismo.

Causa y consecuencia: because, because of, so

We stayed home because it was raining. (frase)
We stayed home because of the rain. (sustantivo)

It was raining, so we stayed home. (consecuencia)
Prices rose sharply. As a result, sales fell. (más formal)

Due to es más formal que *because of*: *The flight was delayed due to fog.*

Al leer, **as** y **since** pueden despistar: a veces significan «porque» (*As it was late, we left*), y *since* también significa «desde» (unidad 3).

Errores típicos de hispanohablantes

- ~~Despite it was cold, …~~ → **Although it was cold** o **Despite the cold**.
- ~~In spite the rain~~ → **In spite of the rain**. Lleva *of*; *despite* no.
- ~~However it was late, we continued.~~ → **Although it was late, …** o **It was late. However, …**
- ~~Because of it was late~~ → **Because it was late**.

Práctica

1. ___ the traffic, we arrived on time.
   A However **B** Although **C** Despite **D** Because
2. ___ she studied a lot, she failed the exam.
   A However **B** Although **C** Despite **D** In spite of
3. The museum was closed. ___, we visited the park.
   A However **B** Although **C** Despite **D** Because of
4. The match was cancelled ___ the storm.
   A because of **B** so **C** because **D** although
5. I was hungry, ___ I made a sandwich.
   A despite **B** so **C** because **D** however
6. My brother is very tidy, ___ I'm quite messy.
   A because of **B** despite **C** so **D** whereas
7. In spite _____ the bad reviews, the film was a success.
8. Despite _____ (feel) ill, she went to work.
9. Sales fell by 20%. As a _____, several shops closed.
10. Toca el conector.
    The plan was expensive. Nevertheless, the council approved it.
11. Toca el verbo principal.
    Even though the tickets were cheap, very few people came to the concert.
12. Ordena la frase.
    We / at / because / home / of / snow / stayed / the
    _____

Cambridge C1 · Reading and Use of English

Part 1 · Multiple-choice cloze (1–8)

Read the text and choose the answer (A, B, C or D) that fits each gap best.

Working from home

(1) working from home has many advantages, it also has some drawbacks. For one thing, you save time **(2)** you don't have to travel. **(3)**, some people feel lonely. This is mainly **(4)** the lack of contact with colleagues. **(5)** being more flexible, home workers often work longer hours and find it hard to **(6)** off at the end of the day. Some companies have **(7)** a mixed model. **(8)**, employees come to the office two or three days a week.

1	**A** However	**B** Whereas	**C** Although	**D** Despite
2	**A** because of	**B** so	**C** because	**D** due to
3	**A** Even though	**B** However	**C** Although	**D** Despite
4	**A** because	**B** as	**C** due to	**D** since
5	**A** However	**B** Although	**C** Despite	**D** Even
6	**A** switch	**B** turn	**C** put	**D** set
7	**A** adapted	**B** admitted	**C** adopted	**D** accepted
8	**A** Due to	**B** So that	**C** As a result	**D** Because of

Part 2 · Open cloze (9–16)

Read the text and write one word in each gap.

Cities and the countryside

Some people love living in big cities, **(9)** others can't stand the noise. Cities offer more jobs and entertainment. On the **(10)** hand, they are expensive: rents have risen a lot **(11)** the last ten years. Many young people are moving to the countryside because **(12)** the high prices. **(13)** though villages are cheaper, they have fewer services. In **(14)** of this, the number of remote workers in villages is growing. Some villages have even offered free houses to attract new residents. **(15)** a result, schools that were about to close have stayed open. The question is **(16)** this trend will last.

Part 3 · Word formation (17–24)

Use the word in capitals to form a word that fits each gap.

> **Living in the city**
>
> One clear advantage of city life is the **(17)** CONVENIENT of having everything nearby, and public transport is usually **(18)** RELY. However, the cost of **(19)** ACCOMMODATE has risen so much that it has become **(20)** AFFORD for many young people. Noise and **(21)** POLLUTE are other common complaints. **(22)** CONSEQUENT, more and more families are moving to small towns, where life is more **(23)** PEACE, even though the **(24)** CHOOSE of jobs is smaller.

Part 4 · Key word transformation (25–30)

Complete the second sentence so that it means the same as the first. Use the word given without changing it, and write between three and six words.

25. Although it was raining, we went for a walk.

    DESPITE

    We went for a walk _____.

26. The flight was cancelled because of the storm.

    DUE

    The flight was cancelled _____ storm.

27. She was tired, but she kept studying.

    SPITE

    _____ tired, she kept studying.

28. He didn't study, so he failed the exam.

    BECAUSE

    He failed the exam _____ study.

29. I like coffee. My sister, however, prefers tea.

    WHEREAS

    I like coffee _____ tea.

30. Prices went up, so fewer people travelled.

    RESULT

    Prices went up. _____ fewer people travelled.

Lectura · Should homework be banned?

In some countries schools have reduced homework or even stopped giving it, and the debate has reached Spain. Supporters of homework argue that it helps students to practise what they have learnt.

However, critics point out that many children spend hours on tasks which do not improve their results. Moreover, because not all families can help their children, homework may increase inequality. Despite these concerns, most teachers do not want to ban homework completely. Instead, they suggest shorter, more creative tasks, such as reading a book or interviewing a grandparent.

Vocabulario

homework deberes · **reduce** reducir · **reach** llegar a · **supporter** defensor/a, partidario/a · **argue that** sostener que · **critic** crítico/a · **point out** señalar · **improve** mejorar · **moreover** además · **increase** aumentar · **inequality** desigualdad · **concern** preocupación · **ban** prohibir · **instead** en su lugar · **such as** como (por ejemplo) · **interview** entrevistar

Preguntas

1. What do supporters of homework believe?

   A It increases inequality. **B** It helps students practise. **C** It should be banned.

   D It should be creative.

2. Why may homework increase inequality?

   A Because some families cannot help their children. **B** Because teachers give different tasks.

   C Because it is boring. **D** Because it is too long.

3. What do most teachers propose?

   A Only reading at home. **B** Giving more homework. **C** Shorter and more creative tasks.

   D Banning homework completely.

Narrar en pasado

Past continuous, past perfect y used to.

Teoría

Tres tiempos para contar una historia

Para contar algo que pasó, el inglés combina tres tiempos. Cada uno tiene un papel:

Tiempo	Papel en la historia	Ejemplo
Past simple	Los hechos principales, uno detrás de otro	I **opened** the door and **saw** a cat.
Past continuous	El fondo: lo que estaba pasando	It **was raining** and people **were running**.
Past perfect	Lo que había pasado antes	Someone **had left** the window open.

Past continuous: lo que estaba pasando

was / were + verbo-ing

Describe una acción en progreso en un momento del pasado. Muy a menudo, otra acción corta (past simple) la interrumpe:

I was cooking when the phone rang.
While we were walking home, it started to snow.

When suele ir con la acción corta y **while** con la larga.

Past perfect: el pasado del pasado

had + participio

Se usa cuando ya estás contando algo en pasado y necesitas ir **más atrás**:

When I arrived at the station, the train had already left.
→ Primero se fue el tren; después llegué yo.

Compara: *When I arrived, the train **left*** = llegué y en ese momento salió. Con *had left*, ya no estaba.

Al leer, **'d** puede ser *had* o *would*. Si detrás va un participio, es *had*: *She'd finished* = she had finished.

Used to: costumbres que ya no existen

used to + infinitivo

I **used to** play football every weekend. (antes sí, ahora no)
There **used to** be a cinema here. (antes había, ya no)
Did you **use to** live in Madrid? · I **didn't use to** like coffee.

No confundir con **be used to + -ing** (estar acostumbrado), de la unidad 1 del examen: *I'm used to getting up early.*

Errores típicos de hispanohablantes

- ~~When I was child, I was going to the beach every summer.~~ → **I used to go** o **I went**. El imperfecto español de costumbre («iba») no es past continuous.
- ~~I use to play tennis.~~ (hablando del pasado) → **I used to play tennis.**
- ~~When I arrived, she already left.~~ → **she had already left**.
- ~~I was knowing the answer.~~ → **I knew the answer.** Verbos de estado (know, like, want, believe) no van en continuo.

Práctica

1. I ___ a shower when the lights went out.
   A have had **B** had had **C** had **D** was having
2. By the time the police arrived, the thieves ___.
   A were escaping **B** have escaped **C** had escaped **D** escaped
3. When I was a child, I ___ to the beach every summer.
   A used to go **B** was going **C** had gone **D** use to go
4. ___ she was reading, her brother was watching TV.
   A During **B** For **C** While **D** When
5. She didn't recognise me because she ___ me for years.
   A hadn't seen **B** didn't see **C** wasn't seeing **D** hasn't seen
6. There ___ a bakery on this corner, but it closed.
   A was being **B** had been being **C** is used to be **D** used to be
7. I didn't _____ to like vegetables, but now I love them.
8. What _____ you doing at 9 o'clock last night?
9. When we got to the cinema, the film had already _____. (start)
10. Toca el verbo principal.
    While I was waiting for the bus, I met an old friend.
11. ¿Qué significa "She'd left"?
    A She did left. **B** She had left. **C** She would left. **D** She has left.
12. Ordena la frase.
    It / house / left / raining / the / was / we / when
    _____

Cambridge C1 · Reading and Use of English

Part 1 · Multiple-choice cloze (1–8)

Read the text and choose the answer (A, B, C or D) that fits each gap best.

The night the lights went out

It was a cold winter evening and the snow was **(1)** heavily. I was **(2)** the dishes when suddenly all the lights went out. At first I **(3)** it was just a problem in my flat, but when I looked out of the window, the whole street was in **(4)** darkness. My neighbours had **(5)** candles and were standing outside, chatting. Nobody knew what had **(6)**. An old man told us that the same thing used to happen all the **(7)** when he was young. The power finally came **(8)** at midnight, but by then we had become friends.

1	**A** dropping	**B** pouring	**C** falling	**D** landing
2	**A** making	**B** doing	**C** having	**D** taking
3	**A** considered	**B** expected	**C** pretended	**D** assumed
4	**A** full	**B** entire	**C** complete	**D** whole
5	**A** fired	**B** lit	**C** heated	**D** sparked
6	**A** made	**B** done	**C** happened	**D** passed
7	**A** way	**B** day	**C** while	**D** time
8	**A** back	**B** again	**C** up	**D** round

Part 2 · Open cloze (9–16)

Read the text and write one word in each gap.

How I met my best friend

I met Laura when we **(9)** both eleven. I had **(10)** moved to a new town and I didn't know anybody. On my first day at school, I **(11)** sitting alone at lunch when she came over and asked **(12)** she could join me. We started talking and discovered that we **(13)** to watch the same cartoons when we were little. From that day on, we **(14)** inseparable. We used to walk to school together and spend hours on the phone, **(15)** annoyed our parents. Thirty years later, we still talk every week, **(16)** though she lives in Canada now.

Part 3 · Word formation (17–24)

Use the word in capitals to form a word that fits each gap.

> **An unexpected journey**
>
> The trip started **(17)** DISASTER: our flight was delayed and we missed our **(18)** CONNECT. We were **(19)** EXHAUST when we finally arrived, but the hotel staff were incredibly **(20)** HELP. To our **(21)** AMAZE, they had **(22)** GRADE our room to a suite with a sea view. Looking back, it was one of the most **(23)** FORGET holidays I've ever had, despite its **(24)** PROMISE start.

Part 4 · Key word transformation (25–30)

Complete the second sentence so that it means the same as the first. Use the word given without changing it, and write between three and six words.

25. When I was a child I didn't like vegetables.

    USED

    I _____ vegetables when I was a child.

26. The film started before we arrived at the cinema.

    ALREADY

    When we arrived at the cinema, the film _____.

27. I was having a shower when the phone rang.

    WHILE

    The phone rang _____ a shower.

28. We went to the beach every summer when I was a child.

    USED

    We _____ the beach every summer when I was a child.

29. She finished her homework and then she went out.

    AFTER

    She went out _____ her homework.

30. It was the first time I had seen the sea.

    NEVER

    I _____ the sea before.

Lectura · The wrong train

Last winter I was travelling to Edinburgh for a job interview. I had prepared everything carefully the night before: my clothes were ready and I had printed my train ticket. But while I was reading my notes on the platform, I didn't notice that the platform number had changed. I got on the first train that arrived and fell asleep. When I woke up, the train was crossing a bridge and I could see the sea. I realised that I had

taken the train to Glasgow. I arrived two hours late, but they gave me the job anyway: the manager said she had once done exactly the same thing.

Vocabulario

job interview entrevista de trabajo · **carefully** con cuidado · **the night before** la noche anterior · **print** imprimir · **platform** andén · **notice** darse cuenta de · **get on** subirse a (un tren, un bus) · **fall asleep** quedarse dormido · **wake up (woke, woken)** despertarse · **bridge** puente · **realise** darse cuenta · **anyway** de todos modos · **manager** director/a, jefe/a · **once** una vez

Preguntas

1. Why was the writer going to Edinburgh?

   A To see the sea. **B** For a holiday. **C** For a job interview. **D** To visit a friend.

2. Why did the writer take the wrong train?

   A The ticket was wrong. **B** The train was late. **C** He did not notice the platform had changed. **D** He arrived late at the station.

3. Why did the manager give him the job?

   A He apologised. **B** Nobody else applied. **C** She had made the same mistake once. **D** He had excellent notes.

Condicionales 0, 1 y 2

Situaciones reales e hipotéticas.

Teoría

La idea: ¿qué tan real es la condición?

Un condicional tiene dos partes: la **condición** (con *if*) y el **resultado**. El tiempo verbal te dice cuánto de real es la situación:

Tipo	Situación	Forma
0	Siempre es verdad	If + presente, presente
1	Posible en el futuro	If + presente, will + infinitivo
2	Imaginaria o poco probable	If + pasado, would + infinitivo

Condicional 0: verdades generales

If you heat ice, it melts.
If I drink coffee at night, I can't sleep.

If aquí funciona casi como *when* («siempre que»).

Condicional 1: lo que puede pasar

If it rains tomorrow, we will stay at home.
You'll miss the bus if you don't hurry.

Regla de oro: después de *if* nunca va *will*. Lo mismo con **when, as soon as, unless, before, until**:

I'll call you when I **arrive**. ✓ · ~~when I will arrive~~ ✗

Unless = if not: *You won't pass unless you study.* = if you don't study.

Condicional 2: lo imaginario

If I had more money, I would travel more. (no tengo)
If I were you, I wouldn't buy it. (consejo)
What would you do if you won the lottery?

El pasado aquí **no habla del pasado**: habla de un presente o futuro imaginario. Con *be* se usa **were** para todas las personas, sobre todo en «If I were you».

En los textos: if no siempre va primero

El orden puede cambiar. Si *if* va primero, se pone coma; si va segundo, no:

If you need help, call me. · Call me if you need help.

Al leer, busca el esqueleto en la parte **sin if**: esa es la frase principal.

Errores típicos de hispanohablantes

- ~~If it will rain, …~~ → **If it rains, …**
- ~~If I would have money, …~~ → **If I had money, …** (en español: «si tuviera», nunca «si tendría»).
- ~~If I was you…~~ → **If I were you…** (en el examen, mejor *were*).
- ~~I'll tell you when I will know.~~ → **when I know**.

Práctica

1. If you mix red and white, you ___ pink.
   A would get **B** will got **C** got **D** get
2. If it ___ tomorrow, we'll cancel the trip.
   A will rain **B** rained **C** would rain **D** rains
3. If I ___ rich, I would buy a house by the sea.
   A were **B** will be **C** am **D** would be
4. I'll phone you as soon as I ___ home.
   A would get **B** will get **C** got **D** get
5. You won't pass the exam ___ you study harder.
   A when **B** as soon as **C** unless **D** if
6. If I were you, I ___ that email.
   A won't send **B** wouldn't send **C** didn't send **D** don't send
7. What _____ you do if you lost your passport abroad?
8. If she _____ (have) more time, she would learn to paint.
9. If you don't hurry, you _____ miss the train.
10. Toca el verbo principal (el de la parte sin if).
    If the weather is good this weekend, we will go hiking in the mountains.
11. ¿Qué significa? "If I had a car, I would drive to work."
    A Tuve coche antes. **B** No tengo coche. **C** Voy a comprar un coche. **D** Tengo coche.
12. Ordena la frase.
    I / I / If / apologise / were / would / you
    _____

Cambridge C1 · Reading and Use of English

Part 1 · Multiple-choice cloze (1–8)

Read the text and choose the answer (A, B, C or D) that fits each gap best.

Before you go hiking

If you **(1)** off early in the morning, you will avoid the worst of the heat. Always check the weather **(2)** before you leave. If there is a **(3)** of storms, don't go. Unless you know the area well, **(4)** to the marked paths. If you get **(5)**, call the emergency number and stay where you are. Everybody can **(6)** a mistake about the route, so carry a map as well as your phone. If I were you, I would also **(7)** a small first-aid kit. If everyone followed these simple rules, mountain rescue teams would be much less **(8)**.

1	**A** put	**B** set	**C** take	**D** get
2	**A** forecast	**B** view	**C** guess	**D** prediction
3	**A** doubt	**B** risk	**C** worry	**D** fear
4	**A** tie	**B** fix	**C** stick	**D** hold
5	**A** gone	**B** missed	**C** lost	**D** lacked
6	**A** make	**B** have	**C** take	**D** do
7	**A** fill	**B** pack	**C** store	**D** load
8	**A** full	**B** busy	**C** filled	**D** crowded

Part 2 · Open cloze (9–16)

Read the text and write one word in each gap.

What would you do?

If you **(9)** a wallet in the street, what would you do? Most people say they **(10)** take it to the police. Researchers in several countries left wallets in public places to see what **(11)** happen. Surprisingly, wallets were more likely to be returned **(12)** they contained money. **(13)** there is no money inside, people don't feel the same responsibility. Psychologists think that if people kept the money, they **(14)** feel like thieves. **(15)** someone finds a lost phone, they usually return it too. But remember: you probably won't get anything back **(16)** you report the loss.

Part 3 · Word formation (17–24)

Use the word in capitals to form a word that fits each gap.

> **Saving energy at home**
>
> If you want to make your home more **(17)** EFFICIENCY, start with the **(18)** HEAT system. If you lower the temperature by one degree, your energy **(19)** CONSUME will fall noticeably. **(20)** SURPRISE, many people leave devices on standby all night, which is completely **(21)** NECESSARY. If everyone switched them off, the **(22)** SAVE would be enormous. **(23)** ADD, new windows can keep the heat in. They are expensive, but in the long term they are a **(24)** WORTH investment.

Part 4 · Key word transformation (25–30)

Complete the second sentence so that it means the same as the first. Use the word given without changing it, and write between three and six words.

25. I don't have a car, so I can't drive to work.

    IF

    I would drive to work _____ a car.

26. Don't touch that, or you'll get burnt.

    IF

    You'll get burnt _____ that.

27. You can't come in without a ticket.

    UNLESS

    You can't come in _____ a ticket.

28. My advice is to see a doctor.

    WERE

    If _____ see a doctor.

29. When you heat water to 100°C, it boils.

    IF

    Water boils _____ to 100°C.

30. I'll only lend you the money if you promise to pay it back.

    UNLESS

    I won't lend you the money _____ to pay it back.

Lectura · What if we all worked four days a week?

If you could choose, would you work four longer days or five shorter ones? Several companies in the UK have tested a four-day week without cutting salaries. Most of them found that if employees have a

three-day weekend, they come back more rested and make fewer mistakes. However, the system doesn't work for every job. If a hospital closed on Fridays, patients would suffer, so hospitals would need more staff to cover the extra day. Experts believe that the four-day week will spread slowly unless governments decide to support it.

Vocabulario

choose elegir · **longer** más largo · **test** probar · **cut** recortar · **salary** sueldo · **employee** empleado/a · **rested** descansado · **make a mistake** cometer un error · **every** todo, cada · **suffer** sufrir · **staff** personal, plantilla · **cover** cubrir · **spread** extenderse · **unless** a menos que · **support** apoyar

Preguntas

1. What did the UK companies test?

   A Lower salaries. **B** Working from home. **C** A four-day week with the same salary.

   D Shorter holidays.

2. What did most companies find?

   A Employees were more rested. **B** Employees made more mistakes. **C** Salaries had to be cut.

   D Employees wanted to work five days.

3. Why is a four-day week difficult for hospitals?

   A They would need more staff. **B** Doctors don't want it. **C** Patients prefer Fridays.

   D It is illegal.

Verbo + -ing o + to

enjoy doing, decide to do, stop/remember/try.

Teoría

El problema

Cuando un verbo va seguido de otro, el segundo puede ir en **-ing** o con **to + infinitivo**. Depende del primer verbo, y no hay una regla perfecta: hay que aprender los más frecuentes. La buena noticia es que son pocos y salen mucho en el examen.

> I enjoy **reading**. · I want **to read**.

Verbos que van con -ing

enjoy, finish, avoid, mind, suggest, consider, keep, practise, imagine, miss, deny, can't stand, don't mind, give up, look forward to

> She **avoids driving** at night. · Would you **mind closing** the window? · I'**m looking forward to seeing** you.

Y **siempre -ing después de una preposición** (about, of, at, for, without, before, after…): *She's good at* ***drawing****.* · *Thanks for* ***helping****.*

Ojo: en *look forward to* y *be used to*, el *to* es preposición → -ing.

Verbos que van con to + infinitivo

want, decide, hope, plan, agree, refuse, promise, offer, manage, afford, learn, seem, need, would like

> We **decided to stay**. · He **refused to pay**. · I can't **afford to buy** a car. · She **managed to finish** on time.

Muchos hablan de **planes, decisiones o intenciones hacia el futuro**; eso ayuda a recordarlos.

Verbos que cambian de significado

Verbo	+ -ing	+ to
stop	dejar de: *I stopped* ***smoking****.*	parar para: *I stopped* ***to smoke****.*
remember	recordar algo pasado: *I remember* ***meeting*** *him.*	acordarse de hacer: *Remember* ***to lock*** *the door.*
forget	olvidar algo pasado: *I'll never forget* ***seeing*** *the sea.*	olvidarse de hacer: *Don't forget* ***to call****.*

try	probar a ver qué pasa: *Try **restarting** it.*	intentar (cuesta): *I tried **to open** it, but I couldn't.*

like, love, hate, start, begin, continue admiten los dos casi sin cambio: *I like swimming / to swim.*

Errores típicos de hispanohablantes

- ~~I enjoy to read.~~ → **I enjoy reading.**
- ~~I'm looking forward to see you.~~ → **to seeing you**.
- ~~She suggested to go out.~~ → **She suggested going out.**
- ~~I want that you come.~~ → **I want you to come.** En inglés no se dice «want that».
- ~~Before to leave, …~~ → **Before leaving, …** Después de preposición, -ing.

Práctica

1. I really enjoy ___ in the sea.
   A swam **B** swimming **C** to swim **D** swim
2. They decided ___ a new flat.
   A buy **B** to buy **C** buying **D** bought
3. I'm looking forward to ___ you next week.
   A seeing **B** have seen **C** saw **D** see
4. He stopped ___ because it was bad for his health.
   A smoking **B** smoked **C** to smoke **D** smoke
5. Please remember ___ the lights before you go.
   A turning off **B** turned off **C** turn off **D** to turn off
6. We can't afford ___ on holiday this year.
   A gone **B** go **C** to go **D** going
7. My boss wants ___ the report today.
   A that I finish **B** me finish **C** me to finish **D** me finishing
8. Would you mind _____ (open) the window?
9. She left without _____ (say) goodbye.
10. He promised _____ call me back.
11. Toca el verbo principal.
    Many people who try to learn a language alone give up after a few months.
12. Ordena la frase.
    I / favourite / forget / meeting / my / never / will / writer
    _____

Cambridge C1 · Reading and Use of English

Part 1 · Multiple-choice cloze (1–8)

Read the text and choose the answer (A, B, C or D) that fits each gap best.

Learning to cook

I had never **(1)** much interest in cooking, but living alone forced me to **(2)** it a try. At first I **(3)** to follow recipes exactly, but I kept **(4)** silly mistakes. Once I forgot **(5)** salt for a whole week. Now I really **(6)** trying new dishes, and I've stopped **(7)** takeaway food every weekend. My friends say they can't wait **(8)** my next dinner party.

1	**A** made	**B** shown	**C** done	**D** given
2	**A** give	**B** make	**C** have	**D** take
3	**A** tried	**B** avoided	**C** minded	**D** enjoyed
4	**A** making	**B** doing	**C** having	**D** taking
5	**A** buy	**B** to buy	**C** buying	**D** bought
6	**A** want	**B** decide	**C** enjoy	**D** hope
7	**A** ordering	**B** ordered	**C** to order	**D** order
8	**A** come to	**B** to coming to	**C** coming to	**D** to come to

Part 2 · Open cloze (9–16)

Read the text and write one word in each gap.

A month without social media

Last year I decided **(9)** give up social media for a month. I was tired **(10)** wasting hours every evening. At first I couldn't stop **(11)** my phone, even though there was nothing to see. After a week, though, I started to look forward **(12)** my quiet evenings. I spent them reading, which I hadn't done for years, and I got used **(13)** going to bed earlier. I don't regret doing it at **(14)**. Now I'm back on social media, but I try to limit my time on it. My advice? Instead **(15)** reaching for your phone when you're bored, try **(16)** for a walk.

Part 3 · Word formation (17–24)

Use the word in capitals to form a word that fits each gap.

The benefits of volunteering

Volunteering is a **(17)** REWARD experience. It helps people develop **(18)** CONFIDENT, and many **(19)** EMPLOY value it on a CV. Popular **(20)** ACTIVE include teaching children to read and helping to reduce **(21)** LONELY among older people. You don't need any special **(22)** QUALIFY, just the **(23)** WILLING to help. However, some people stop volunteering because they find it **(24)** STRESS.

Part 4 · Key word transformation (25–30)

Complete the second sentence so that it means the same as the first. Use the word given without changing it, and write between three and six words.

25. I'd prefer not to go out tonight.

    FEEL

    I don't _____ out tonight.

26. Would it be a problem if I opened the window?

    MIND

    Would you _____ the window?

27. Please remember that you have to lock the door.

    FORGET

    Don't _____ the door.

28. It's not worth repairing that old TV.

    POINT

    There's _____ that old TV.

29. She managed to finish the race.

    SUCCEEDED

    She _____ the race.

30. I stopped smoking five years ago.

    GAVE

    I _____ five years ago.

Lectura · Learning to fail

Most of us avoid doing things that we are not good at. We are afraid of looking stupid, so we stop trying before we have really started. A teacher in Barcelona decided to change this by inventing a "mistake of the week" competition. Every Friday, students share the biggest mistake they have made and explain what they learnt from it. At first many of them refused to take part, but after a few weeks they started looking forward to it. The teacher says that her students now keep trying for longer and don't mind making mistakes in front of others.

Vocabulario

avoid evitar · **be good at** dársele bien algo a alguien · **be afraid of** tener miedo de · **look stupid** quedar como un tonto · **by doing** haciendo (modo) · **competition** concurso · **share** compartir · **learn from** aprender de · **at first** al principio · **refuse** negarse · **take part** participar · **keep doing** seguir haciendo · **not mind** no importar · **in front of** delante de

Preguntas

1. Why do we often stop trying new things?

   A We are too busy. **B** We are afraid of looking stupid. **C** We are not interested.

   D Teachers don't help us.

2. What happens every Friday in the teacher's class?

   A Students correct each other's homework. **B** Students choose the best student.

   C Students share a mistake and what they learnt. **D** Students take an exam.

3. How have the students changed?

   A They make fewer mistakes. **B** They prefer working alone. **C** They refuse to take part.

   D They keep trying for longer.

Tercer condicional y mixtos

Hablar de un pasado que no pasó.

Teoría

La idea: un pasado que no pasó

En la unidad 7 viste los condicionales 0, 1 y 2. El **tercer condicional** habla de algo que **ya no se puede cambiar**: imaginas un pasado distinto y su resultado, también en el pasado.

Tipo	Situación	Forma
2	Presente o futuro imaginario	If + pasado, would + infinitivo
3	Pasado imaginario	If + **past perfect**, **would have** + participio

If I had studied more, I would have passed the exam.
Si hubiera estudiado más, habría aprobado el examen. (No estudié y suspendí.)

Cómo se forma

Condición: if + **had** + participio (past perfect).
Resultado: would have + participio.

If we had left earlier, we wouldn't have missed the train.
She would have called you if she had known.
What would you have done if you had been there?

En lugar de *would* puedes usar **could have** (habría podido) o **might have** (quizá habría):

If you had asked me, I could have helped you.

La trampa al escuchar: 'd = had o would

En la lengua hablada, **'d** puede ser **had** o **would**, y en el tercer condicional aparecen los dos:

If I**'d** known, I**'d** have come.
= If I **had** known, I **would** have come.

Truco: si después de 'd viene un **participio** (known), es **had**. Si viene **have** o un infinitivo, es **would**. Y *would have* suena casi «wouldof»: *I'd've come*.

Condicionales mixtos: pasado y presente mezclados

A veces una condición del **pasado** tiene un resultado en el **presente**, o al revés. Entonces se mezclan las formas:

Pasado → presente (if + past perfect, would + infinitivo):

> If I had taken that job, I would be rich now.
> *Si hubiera aceptado ese trabajo, ahora sería rico.*

Presente → pasado (if + pasado, would have + participio):

> If I spoke German, I would have understood the film.
> *Si hablara alemán (no lo hablo), habría entendido la película.*

Pista: busca palabras de tiempo como **now, today, yesterday, last year**. Te dicen qué parte va en presente y cuál en pasado.

Expresar arrepentimiento y críticas

El tercer condicional es la forma natural de hablar de errores y arrepentimientos. Fíjate también en estas estructuras de la misma familia (las verás en la unidad 10):

> I should have told you. (Debería habértelo dicho.)
> You shouldn't have shouted. (No deberías haber gritado.)

Errores típicos de hispanohablantes

- ~~If I would have known…~~ → **If I had known…** En la parte del *if* nunca va *would*, igual que en español no decimos «si habría sabido».
- ~~I would had gone.~~ → **I would have gone.** Después de *would*, siempre **have**.
- ~~If I had went…~~ → **If I had gone…** Hace falta el **participio**, no el pasado.
- Mezclar el tiempo sin querer: *If I had studied medicine, I would have been a doctor now* → mejor **I would be a doctor now**, porque el resultado es presente.

Práctica

1. If you ___ me, I would have helped you.
   A asked **B** had asked **C** have asked **D** would ask
2. If she had left on time, she ___ the flight.
   A wouldn't miss **B** didn't miss **C** wouldn't have missed **D** hadn't missed
3. If I ___ that job in 2020, I would be living in London now.
   A had accepted **B** would accept **C** have accepted **D** accepted
4. If he spoke French, he ___ the instructions yesterday.
   A would have understood **B** would understand **C** had understood **D** understood
5. «If I'd known, I'd have come.» ¿Qué significa cada 'd?
   A would … had **B** would … would **C** had … had **D** had … would

6. If we had taken a taxi, we ___ arrived on time.
   A might **B** had **C** would **D** might have

7. Elige la frase correcta.
   A If I had known, I would have told you. **B** If I would have known, I would have told you.
   C If I knew, I would have tell you. **D** If I had knew, I would told you.

8. If it _____ (not / rain), we would have gone to the beach.

9. She would have passed if she _____ (study) harder.

10. If I had saved more money, I _____ (be) on holiday now.

11. Toca el verbo de la oración principal (el resultado).
    If the team had trained harder, they would have won the final.

12. Ordena la frase.
    I / I / If / had / have / hello / said / seen / would / you
    _____

Cambridge C1 · Reading and Use of English

Part 1 · Multiple-choice cloze (1–8)

Read the text and choose the answer (A, B, C or D) that fits each gap best.

> **A lucky escape**
>
> If Tom hadn't **(1)** the bus that morning, he would never have met Ana. He was standing at the bus stop in the pouring rain when a woman **(2)** over and offered him a lift. It turned out that she worked in the same **(3)** of business as him, and they got **(4)** immediately. Looking **(5)**, Tom says that rainy morning changed his life. If he had **(6)** the bus, as he usually did, they would never have **(7)** paths. And if his alarm clock had **(8)** off on time, he would probably still be single.

1	**A** missed	**B** dropped	**C** failed	**D** lost
2	**A** pulled	**B** turned	**C** pushed	**D** drew
3	**A** line	**B** queue	**C** row	**D** string
4	**A** over	**B** through	**C** by	**D** on
5	**A** ahead	**B** after	**C** back	**D** behind
6	**A** caught	**B** arrived	**C** won	**D** reached
7	**A** crossed	**B** joined	**C** passed	**D** met
8	**A** gone	**B** sounded	**C** started	**D** rung

Part 2 · Open cloze (9–16)

Read the text and write one word in each gap.

> **The mistake that made millions**
>
> In 1968, a scientist called Spencer Silver was trying to create a very strong glue. Instead, he invented one **(9)** was so weak that it hardly stuck at all. If he **(10)** been more successful, the sticky note might never have existed. For years nobody knew what to do with it. Then a colleague, Art Fry, **(11)** was frustrated because his bookmarks kept falling out of his song book, had an idea. If Fry **(12)** not sung in a church choir, he might never have thought of it. The notes went on sale in 1980, and **(13)** then they have become one of the best-known office products in the world. Silver later said he would **(14)** given up if his colleagues hadn't encouraged him. The company would be **(15)** poorer today if it hadn't been for that weak glue. It shows that a mistake can sometimes turn **(16)** to be a great idea.

Part 3 · Word formation (17–24)

Use the word in capitals to form a word that fits each gap.

> **Regrets of a lottery winner**
>
> When Mark won the lottery, he made some **(17)** FORTUNE decisions. He gave money to almost everyone, **(18)** INCLUDE people he hardly knew, and he spent a fortune on **(19)** LUXURY cars. If he had asked for **(20)** ADVISE from a **(21)** FINANCE expert, he would have avoided a lot of **(22)** PAIN problems. Now he admits that his behaviour was **(23)** RESPONSIBLE. "If I had been wiser, I'd still be rich," he says with a **(24)** REGRET smile.

Part 4 · Key word transformation (25–30)

Complete the second sentence so that it means the same as the first. Use the word given without changing it, and write between three and six words.

25. I didn't know you were ill, so I didn't visit you.

    WOULD

    If I had known you were ill, I _____ you.

26. We got lost because we didn't take a map.

    IF

    We wouldn't have got lost _____ a map.

27. I didn't study medicine, so I'm not a doctor now.

    WOULD

    If I had studied medicine, I _____ now.

28. She missed the train because she overslept.

    NOT

    If she _____, she would have caught the train.

29. Luckily, he was wearing a helmet, so he wasn't badly hurt.

    BEEN

    If he hadn't been wearing a helmet, he _____ badly hurt.

30. It was only thanks to your help that I passed.

    FOR

    If it _____ your help, I wouldn't have passed.

Lectura · The decision that changed everything

In 1962, a large record company in London rejected a young band from Liverpool. One of the managers said that guitar groups were going out of fashion. The band, of course, was the Beatles. If the company had signed them, it would have become one of the richest in the world. Instead, another label signed them a few months later. Historians sometimes wonder whether music would sound different today if that first meeting had gone well. The manager probably regretted his words for the rest of his life.

Vocabulario

record company discográfica · **reject** rechazar · **band** grupo (de música) · **manager** directivo, gerente · **go out of fashion** pasar de moda · **of course** por supuesto · **sign** fichar, firmar un contrato · **become** convertirse en · **instead** en cambio · **label** sello discográfico · **wonder** preguntarse · **whether** si (en preguntas indirectas) · **go well** salir bien · **probably** probablemente · **regret** arrepentirse de, lamentar

Preguntas

1. Why did the company reject the band?

   A The band was from Liverpool. **B** They thought guitar groups were going out of fashion.

   C They already had the Beatles. **D** The band was too expensive.

2. What would have happened if the company had signed them?

   A It would have become very rich. **B** The Beatles would have split up.

   C Nothing would have changed. **D** It would have closed.

3. Which sentence is a mixed conditional?

   A If the company had signed them, it would have become rich.

   B The manager regretted his words.

   C Music would sound different today if that meeting had gone well. **D** Another label signed them.

Wish e if only

Deseos y arrepentimientos.

Teoría

La idea: desear que algo fuera distinto

Wish (y su versión más intensa, **if only**) sirve para decir que te gustaría que la realidad fuera otra. Igual que en los condicionales, el verbo «retrocede» un tiempo:

Deseo sobre…	Forma	Ejemplo
El **presente**	wish + **pasado**	I wish I had more time. (no lo tengo)
El **pasado**	wish + **past perfect**	I wish I had studied more. (no estudié)
Algo que **otra persona** hace y te molesta	wish + **would**	I wish you would stop talking.

Wish + pasado: el presente que no es

I wish I lived by the sea. (Ojalá viviera junto al mar.)
She wishes she could speak Japanese. (Le gustaría poder hablar japonés.)
I wish it weren't so cold. (Ojalá no hiciera tanto frío.)

Como en el condicional 2, con *be* se prefiere **were** para todas las personas: *I wish I were taller*. En el examen, usa *were*.

En español lo traducimos con **ojalá + imperfecto de subjuntivo**: «ojalá tuviera», «ojalá pudiera».

Wish + past perfect: arrepentimientos

I wish I hadn't eaten so much. (Ojalá no hubiera comido tanto.)
He wishes he had accepted the offer. (Le gustaría haber aceptado la oferta.)

Es la misma idea que el tercer condicional (unidad 9): hablas de un pasado que ya no se puede cambiar.

Wish + would: quejas sobre los demás

Wish + would expresa que te molesta algo que hace otra persona (o una situación) y quieres que cambie:

I wish my neighbours would turn the music down.
I wish it would stop raining!

No se usa con uno mismo: ~~I wish I would…~~. Para tus propios deseos, usa el pasado: **I wish I could…**

If only: lo mismo, con más emoción

If only funciona igual que *wish*, pero suena más intenso o dramático. Muy frecuente en textos narrativos:

If only I knew the answer! (presente)
If only we had left earlier! (pasado)
If only he would listen! (queja)

Errores típicos de hispanohablantes

- ~~I wish I have more money.~~ → **I wish I had more money.** Después de wish, el verbo retrocede.
- ~~I wish I would be taller.~~ → **I wish I were taller.** Would no se usa contigo mismo.
- ~~I wish I didn't go.~~ (para el pasado) → **I wish I hadn't gone.**
- Para desear algo bueno a otra persona no se usa *wish* + frase, sino **hope**: *I hope you **pass** the exam* (espero que apruebes). *Wish* solo con nombre: *I wish you luck*.

Práctica

1. I wish I ___ how to swim. (no sé)
   A had known **B** would know **C** know **D** knew
2. I wish I ___ to the party last night. It was great.
   A go **B** would go **C** had gone **D** went
3. I wish you ___ leaving your clothes on the floor!
   A would stop **B** stop **C** had stopped **D** stopped
4. I wish I ___ taller.
   A were **B** am **C** would be **D** have been
5. If only I ___ her number! I could call her now.
   A had **B** having **C** would have **D** have
6. Elige la frase correcta.
   A I hope you had a great trip tomorrow. **B** I wish you have a great trip.
   C I hope you have a great trip. **D** I wish you would have a great trip.
7. She wishes she _____ (can) drive.
8. I wish I _____ (not / say) that. It was a mistake.
9. If only it _____ (stop) raining! We want to go out.
10. Toca el verbo principal.
    Many people wish they had chosen a different career.
11. «I wish I lived in Paris» significa…
    A Ojalá hubiera vivido en París **B** Vivía en París y me gustaba **C** No vivo en París y me gustaría **D** Viviré en París
12. Ordena la frase.
    I / I / advice / had / listened / to / wish / your
    _____

Cambridge C1 · Reading and Use of English

Part 1 · Multiple-choice cloze (1–8)

Read the text and choose the answer (A, B, C or D) that fits each gap best.

The things we wish we had done

A nurse who **(1)** for dying patients wrote a book about their regrets. Many said, "I wish I hadn't worked so **(2)**." Others wished they had **(3)** in touch with old friends, and many wished they had **(4)** their feelings more openly. Instead, they had **(5)** their emotions to avoid conflict. Some wished they had **(6)** themselves be happier. The book became a best-seller and was **(7)** into more than thirty languages. Its message is simple: don't wait until it's too late to **(8)** the most of your life.

1	**A** took	**B** looked	**C** cared	**D** minded
2	**A** heavy	**B** hardly	**C** hard	**D** strongly
3	**A** put	**B** had	**C** held	**D** kept
4	**A** said	**B** expressed	**C** spoken	**D** told
5	**A** shut	**B** hidden	**C** closed	**D** covered
6	**A** made	**B** allowed	**C** let	**D** got
7	**A** turned	**B** changed	**C** translated	**D** converted
8	**A** make	**B** take	**C** do	**D** get

Part 2 · Open cloze (9–16)

Read the text and write one word in each gap.

If only I had listened

When I was eighteen, my father told me to study something practical, but I didn't listen. Now I wish I **(9)** followed his advice. I chose philosophy. Don't get me wrong: I loved it. But if **(10)** I had known how hard it would be to find a job! Sometimes I wish I **(11)** go back and choose again. My friend Pablo, on the **(12)** hand, studied engineering. He earns a lot, but he wishes he **(13)** more free time. "I wish my boss **(14)** stop sending me emails at midnight," he says. I suppose the answer is to accept our choices **(15)** stop comparing ourselves with others. After all, it's no use crying over spilt milk, **(16)** the saying goes.

Part 3 · Word formation (17–24)

Use the word in capitals to form a word that fits each gap.

> **Learning from mistakes**
>
> Everyone makes mistakes; it is **(17)** POSSIBLE to live without them. The **(18)** DIFFER between successful and unsuccessful people is often their **(19)** ABLE to accept failure. **(20)** FAIL is not the end, but a necessary step. Psychologists say that **(21)** EXCESS worry about the past can lead to **(22)** ANXIOUS. Instead, they recommend careful **(23)** REFLECT on what went wrong, followed by **(24)** PRACTICE steps to improve.

Part 4 · Key word transformation (25–30)

Complete the second sentence so that it means the same as the first. Use the word given without changing it, and write between three and six words.

25. I'm sorry I didn't go to the party.

    WISH

    I _____ to the party.

26. It's a pity I can't speak Japanese.

    ONLY

    If _____ speak Japanese.

27. It annoys me that you keep interrupting me.

    WISH

    I _____ interrupting me.

28. You were wrong not to tell her the truth.

    SHOULD

    You _____ the truth.

29. I regret spending so much money.

    WISH

    I _____ so much money.

30. I regret not studying harder.

    ONLY

    If _____ harder.

Lectura · The top five regrets of the dying

An Australian nurse who worked with patients in their last weeks of life wrote a famous list. The most common regret was "I wish I had lived a life true to myself." Many men said they wished they hadn't

worked so hard. Others wished they had stayed in touch with their friends. Interestingly, nobody said that they wished they had spent more time at the office. The nurse concluded that we should live today in a way that we won't regret tomorrow.

Vocabulario

nurse enfermero/a · **patient** paciente · **last weeks of life** últimas semanas de vida · **regret** arrepentimiento · **true to myself** fiel a mí mismo · **work hard** trabajar mucho · **so hard** tanto · **stay in touch** mantener el contacto · **interestingly** curiosamente · **nobody** nadie · **spend time** pasar tiempo · **conclude** concluir · **in a way** de una manera

Preguntas

1. What was the most common regret?

   A Not living a life true to themselves. **B** Not earning more money. **C** Not working harder.

   D Not travelling more.

2. What did many men wish?

   A That they hadn't worked so hard. **B** That they had more friends at work.

   C That they lived in Australia. **D** That they had worked harder.

3. What did nobody say?

   A That they were true to themselves. **B** That they missed their friends.

   C That they wanted to be happier. **D** That they wished they had spent more time at the office.

Soluciones

Los números con C son los del bloque Cambridge.

Unidad 1 · El esqueleto de la frase

1. has lived
2. received
3. The film
4. finished
5. children
6. tend
7. B
8. B
9. A
10. B
11. Yesterday my parents bought a new car
12. The woman who called you is my boss
13. it
14. there

C1. A (made)
C2. D (tell)
C3. C (make)
C4. D (set)
C5. D (take)
C6. A (challenge)
C7. A (advice)
C8. B (make)
C9. it
C10. it
C11. there
C12. from / to / than
C13. be
C14. do
C15. because / as / since
C16. that / which
C17. successful
C18. motivation
C19. explanations
C20. uncomfortable
C21. learning
C22. encouragement
C23. useful
C24. simplified
C25. dont have to bring
C26. was crowded with
C27. not as tall as
C28. know what time the film
C29. am really interested in
C30. where the station is

Lectura: 1. C · 2. C · 3. D

Unidad 2 · Oraciones de relativo

1. A
2. C
3. C
4. A
5. B
6. A
7. C
8. D
9. whose
10. which
11. when
12. to
13. were
14. has closed
15. The man whose wallet I found gave me a reward

C1. B (close)
C2. D (which)
C3. C (take)
C4. A (raised)
C5. C (experience)
C6. D (wide)
C7. B (favourite)
C8. A (where)
C9. that / which
C10. whom
C11. who
C12. where
C13. whose
C14. when / that
C15. whose
C16. that / who / whom
C17. dependent
C18. willingly
C19. organisers / organizers
C20. considerably
C21. performers
C22. visitors
C23. economic
C24. friendly
C25. whose dog had
C26. where we stayed
C27. who is talking to
C28. when we moved
C29. which i would
C30. that we saw

Lectura: 1. C · 2. D · 3. C

Unidad 3 · Present perfect o past simple

1. B
2. D
3. B
4. B
5. B
6. A
7. yet
8. since
9. for
10. did
11. has doubled
12. I have never been to Ireland

C1. A (made)
C2. D (get)
C3. D (changed)
C4. C (pays)
C5. C (taken)
C6. B (took)
C7. D (lost)
C8. B (done)
C9. have
C10. never
C11. for
C12. since
C13. ago
C14. because / as / since
C15. just
C16. how
C17. remarkable
C18. excitement
C19. numerous
C20. exhibition
C21. enthusiastic
C22. honesty
C23. increasingly
C24. poverty
C25. have worked here for
C26. have never been to
C27. have you had
C28. have not seen peter since
C29. has gone to
C30. have not met for

Lectura: 1. B · 2. B · 3. C

Unidad 4 · La pasiva

1. A
2. B
3. B
4. D
5. C
6. A
7. by
8. be
9. announced
10. have been planted
11. The new hospital,
12. The thief was arrested by the police

C1. B (beans)
C2. A (grown)
C3. A (dry)
C4. D (shipped)
C5. C (ground)
C6. A (added)
C7. C (stirred)
C8. D (cool)
C9. was
C10. the
C11. by
C12. not / never
C13. is
C14. so
C15. why / that
C16. was
C17. officially
C18. architects
C19. equipped
C20. government
C21. construction
C22. journeys
C23. treatment
C24. unemployed
C25. was built in
C26. is being repaired
C27. is said to be
C28. will be announced
C29. had my brakes checked
C30. have not been told

Lectura: 1. D · 2. A · 3. D

Unidad 5 · Conectores de contraste y causa

1. C
2. B
3. A
4. A
5. B
6. D
7. of
8. feeling
9. result
10. Nevertheless,
11. came
12. We stayed at home because of the snow

C1. C (Although)
C2. C (because)
C3. B (However)
C4. C (due to)
C5. C (Despite)
C6. A (switch)
C7. C (adopted)
C8. C (As a result)
C9. whereas / while / but
C10. other
C11. over / in / during / for
C12. of
C13. even
C14. spite
C15. as
C16. whether / if
C17. convenience
C18. reliable
C19. accommodation
C20. unaffordable
C21. pollution
C22. consequently
C23. peaceful
C24. choice
C25. despite the rain
C26. due to the
C27. in spite of being
C28. because he did not
C29. whereas my sister prefers
C30. as a result

Lectura: 1. B · 2. A · 3. C

Unidad 6 · Narrar en pasado

1. D
2. C
3. A
4. C
5. A
6. D
7. use
8. were
9. started
10. met
11. B
12. It was raining when we left the house

C1. C (falling)
C2. B (doing)
C3. D (assumed)
C4. C (complete)
C5. B (lit)
C6. C (happened)
C7. D (time)
C8. A (back)
C9. were
C10. just
C11. was
C12. if / whether
C13. used
C14. were / became
C15. which
C16. even
C17. disastrously
C18. connection
C19. exhausted
C20. helpful
C21. amazement
C22. upgraded
C23. unforgettable
C24. unpromising
C25. never used to like
C26. had already started
C27. while i was having
C28. used to go to
C29. after she had finished
C30. had never seen

Lectura: 1. C · 2. C · 3. C

Unidad 7 · Condicionales 0, 1 y 2

1. D
2. D
3. A
4. D
5. C
6. B
7. would
8. had
9. will
10. will go
11. B
12. If I were you I would apologise

C1. B (set)
C2. A (forecast)
C3. B (risk)
C4. C (stick)
C5. C (lost)
C6. A (make)
C7. B (pack)
C8. B (busy)
C9. found
C10. would
C11. would
C12. if / when
C13. if / when
C14. would
C15. when / if
C16. unless
C17. efficient
C18. heating
C19. consumption
C20. surprisingly
C21. unnecessary
C22. savings
C23. additionally
C24. worthwhile
C25. if i had
C26. if you touch
C27. unless you have
C28. i were you i would
C29. if you heat it
C30. unless you promise

Lectura: 1. C · 2. A · 3. A

Unidad 8 · Verbo + -ing o + to

1. B
2. B
3. A
4. A
5. D
6. C
7. C
8. opening
9. saying
10. to
11. give up
12. I will never forget meeting my favourite writer

C1. B (shown)
C2. A (give)
C3. A (tried)
C4. A (making)
C5. B (to buy)
C6. C (enjoy)
C7. A (ordering)
C8. D (to come to)
C9. to
C10. of
C11. checking / touching
C12. to
C13. to
C14. all
C15. of
C16. going
C17. rewarding
C18. confidence
C19. employers
C20. activities
C21. loneliness
C22. qualifications / qualification
C23. willingness
C24. stressful
C25. feel like going
C26. mind if i opened
C27. forget to lock
C28. no point in repairing
C29. succeeded in finishing
C30. gave up smoking

Lectura: 1. B · 2. C · 3. D

Unidad 9 · Tercer condicional y mixtos

1. B
2. C
3. A
4. A
5. D
6. D
7. A
8. hadnt rained
9. had studied
10. would be
11. would have won
12. If I had seen you I would have said hello

C1. A (missed)
C2. A (pulled)
C3. A (line)
C4. D (on)
C5. C (back)
C6. A (caught)
C7. A (crossed)
C8. A (gone)
C9. that / which
C10. had
C11. who
C12. had
C13. since
C14. have
C15. much / far / a lot
C16. out
C17. unfortunate
C18. including
C19. luxurious
C20. advice
C21. financial
C22. painful
C23. irresponsible
C24. regretful
C25. would have visited
C26. if we had taken
C27. would be a doctor
C28. had not overslept
C29. would have been
C30. had not been for

Lectura: 1. B · 2. A · 3. C

Unidad 10 · Wish e if only

1. D
2. C
3. A
4. A
5. A
6. C
7. could
8. hadnt said
9. would stop
10. wish
11. C
12. I wish I had listened to your advice

C1. C (cared)
C2. C (hard)
C3. D (kept)
C4. B (expressed)
C5. B (hidden)
C6. C (let)
C7. C (translated)
C8. A (make)
C9. had
C10. only
C11. could
C12. other
C13. had
C14. would
C15. and
C16. as
C17. impossible
C18. difference
C19. ability
C20. failure
C21. excessive
C22. anxiety
C23. reflection
C24. practical
C25. wish i had gone
C26. only i could
C27. wish you would stop
C28. should have told her
C29. wish i had not spent
C30. only i had studied

Lectura: 1. A · 2. A · 3. D

Anexo · Verbos irregulares

Infinitivo	Pasado	Participio	Significado
be	was/were	been	ser, estar
become	became	become	convertirse
begin	began	begun	empezar
break	broke	broken	romper
bring	brought	brought	traer
build	built	built	construir
buy	bought	bought	comprar
catch	caught	caught	coger, atrapar
choose	chose	chosen	elegir
come	came	come	venir
cost	cost	cost	costar
cut	cut	cut	cortar
do	did	done	hacer
draw	drew	drawn	dibujar
drink	drank	drunk	beber
drive	drove	driven	conducir
eat	ate	eaten	comer
fall	fell	fallen	caer
feel	felt	felt	sentir
fight	fought	fought	luchar
find	found	found	encontrar
fly	flew	flown	volar
forget	forgot	forgotten	olvidar
forgive	forgave	forgiven	perdonar
get	got	got	conseguir, llegar
give	gave	given	dar
go	went	gone	ir
grow	grew	grown	crecer
have	had	had	tener
hear	heard	heard	oír
hide	hid	hidden	esconder
hit	hit	hit	golpear
hold	held	held	sostener
hurt	hurt	hurt	herir, doler
keep	kept	kept	guardar, mantener
know	knew	known	saber, conocer
lead	led	led	dirigir, llevar a

learn	learnt/learned	learnt/learned	aprender
leave	left	left	dejar, irse
lend	lent	lent	prestar
let	let	let	dejar, permitir
lie	lay	lain	tumbarse
lose	lost	lost	perder
make	made	made	hacer, fabricar
mean	meant	meant	significar
meet	met	met	conocer, quedar
pay	paid	paid	pagar
put	put	put	poner
read	read	read	leer
ride	rode	ridden	montar
ring	rang	rung	sonar, llamar
rise	rose	risen	subir, elevarse
run	ran	run	correr
say	said	said	decir
see	saw	seen	ver
sell	sold	sold	vender
send	sent	sent	enviar
set	set	set	establecer, poner
shake	shook	shaken	agitar, temblar
shine	shone	shone	brillar
shoot	shot	shot	disparar
show	showed	shown	mostrar
shut	shut	shut	cerrar
sing	sang	sung	cantar
sink	sank	sunk	hundirse
sit	sat	sat	sentarse
sleep	slept	slept	dormir
speak	spoke	spoken	hablar
spend	spent	spent	gastar, pasar (tiempo)
spread	spread	spread	extender
stand	stood	stood	estar de pie
steal	stole	stolen	robar
stick	stuck	stuck	pegar
strike	struck	struck	golpear, impactar
swim	swam	swum	nadar
take	took	taken	coger, llevar
teach	taught	taught	enseñar

tear	tore	torn	romper, rasgar
tell	told	told	contar, decir
think	thought	thought	pensar
throw	threw	thrown	lanzar
understand	understood	understood	entender
wake	woke	woken	despertar
wear	wore	worn	llevar puesto
win	won	won	ganar
write	wrote	written	escribir